

- 1) `:abb` is for abbreviation

For example:

```
abb eti Elitcore Technologies Limited, Ahmedabad
```

So whenever you type `eti` in your Vi editor and press ENTER, SPACE or TAB, `eti` will be replaced by "Elitcore Technologies Limited, Ahmedabad". I use it to create templates for C and C++ programs, like

```
abb CPP #include<iostream> ^M using namespace std; ^M int  
main() ^M { ^M return 0; ^M }
```

Here `^M` is for a new line. Note that to make sure you do not type `^M`, for a new line you have to:

- a) `ctrl+v`
- b) press ENTER

It will display `^M` as above but it means a new line. So, now every time I need a C++ template, I just type CPP and press ENTER, SPACE or TAB.

- 2) `:map` is for mapping some command to some shortcut.

For example, the vi command `:set number` is used to display line numbers in a file for every new line. Let's say we want to set a shortcut for it, say, F2. To map this command to shortcut key, the Vi setting will be:

```
map #2 :set number ^M
```

Same for `:set nonumber`; let's set it to F3:

```
map #3 :set nonumber ^M
```

- 3) `set tabstop=2` is for setting TAB. I want TAB to be equal to 2 spaces, so I set it to 2.

—Shiv Premani, shivpremani@gmail.com



Read a CD volume label

To read the volume label of a CD-ROM from the terminal:

```
$ dd if=/dev/cdwriter bs=1 skip=32808 count=32  
LFYCD_MARCH08 32+0 records in  
32+0 records out  
32 bytes (32 B) copied, 4.02751 seconds, 0.0 kB/s
```

Note: The value, `/dev/cdwriter` depends on your device file.

—Suhail CK, suhailck@gmail.com



Disabling 'shutdown' with Ctrl+Alt+Del

If you get annoyed, when you accidentally reboot the system by pressing the three magic keys, comment out the following line in your `/etc/inittab` file:

```
ca:ctrlaltdel/sbin/shutdown -t3 -r now
```

You may alternatively allow specific users with this capability by changing the line as below and adding the specific login ids in `/etc/shutdown.allow`,

```
ca:ctrlaltdel/sbin/shutdown -a -t3 -r now
```

—Ashish Kushwaha, ashish.knit.cs@yahoo.co.in



More passwd flags

You can change user account details using the `passwd` command—yes, it can do more than changing just the password. Open the new terminal and enter the following commands:

```
passwd -d [user name]
```

where `-d` deletes the user's password.

Some other useful flags are:

- `-l` locks the user account
- `-u` unlocks the user's account
- `-?` is to get help

—Thiyagarajan. R, r.thiyagarajan@yahoo.co.in



Copy/paste in an easier way

Linux offers `Ctrl+C`/`Ctrl+V` paste just like Windows. But it also has a second way of copy/paste: highlight any text and it is automatically copied into X's "Primary" selection buffer—which doesn't change whatever you might have copied with `Ctrl+C`—and you can paste it anywhere by clicking the middle mouse button. Isn't Linux cool?

—Bhuvanesh, bhuvibhuvanesh@gmail.com

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